

Paper 4, Option 4C: Hinduism

Topics	What students need to learn	
1 Religious beliefs, values and teachings	1.1	Beliefs a) Sanatana Dharma, rta, including implications for Hindu belief and practice in their interconnections as reflected historically and in the contemporary world and for the community of believers. b) Karma and the importance of eternal and universal order, with implications for all peoples and the righteous living, law of action and consequences. c) Samsara as a cycle of birth and types of reincarnation and the significance of moksha. Beliefs about the self, death and the afterlife. With reference to the ideas of R Zaehner and I Jamieson.
	1.2	Beliefs about Brahman and also avatars as God in human form a) Brahman: the universal spirit and how he is represented in the world, deities and scripture. b) Krishna: the ideal avatar and the heart of the bhakti movements, ISKCON. c) Rama: accounts of this incarnation of Vishnu, the ideal man and the working out of various types of dharma. d) Shakti: creative power as Goddess, in some contexts worshipped as one of her manifestations believed to be the true form of the Divine. e) Significance of the context of beliefs about Vishnu who descends to the human world as an avatar when needed to re-establish the dharma. With reference to the ideas of J Lipner and S Sivananda.
	1.3	Key moral principles (1) a) The underlying principles of dharma (duty), karma (deeds) and ahimsa (non-violence). b) Values linked with the ashramas (dharma, artha, kama, vairagya and their relationship with moksha). c) Virtues and qualities associated with the gunas. With reference to the ideas of P Bilimoria.